United Healthcare - Clinical Coverage Guideline

Computed Tomography (CT) of Head / Brain Guidelines (Version 2026.1)

Section 1.0 Coverage Scope

This medical policy sets forth diagnostic criteria for outpatient computed tomography. Applicable CPT codes include 70450 and 70460.

Section 4.2.1 Clinical Indication

Patient must have documented neurological signs or symptoms, such as severe persistent headaches with atypical features, dizziness, or visual disturbance.

Section 4.2.2 Duration of Symptoms

Symptoms must persist for at least 6 weeks of active outpatient care prior to imaging.

Section 4.2.3 Previous Conservative Treatment

A documented course of conservative therapy must be attempted without improvement.

Section 4.2.6 Contrast Justification

If intravenous contrast is requested, clinical rationale must establish suspicion of mass or neoplasm.